ISSUE 02

Week of 26 Oct–1 Nov 2026

The Wild MARKETING DUMP

₹0 *no claims to substantiate*

Last week in marketing. Unfiltered.

MCDONALD'S BROKE UP WITH FIFA p.3
32 years. Not lovin' it anymore.

EVERY SUPPLEMENT AD FLUNKED p.10
60 out of 60. Even the protein couldn't lift this.

NUTELLA, MEET YOUR DESI RIVAL p.8
It's made of til and gud.

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MCDONALD'S LEAVES THE WORLD CUP

After 32 years and its biggest campaign ever.

1994

The year McDonald's started sponsoring the World Cup.

~$80M

Committed to the 2026 cycle, in 100+ markets.

+0.8%

Same-store sales growth in Q2. Buzz went up, visits didn't.

1/3

Of its Q2 traffic loss, which McDonald's tied to the campaign.

> *"Underperformed versus our expectations."*
>
> MCDONALD'S CFO, ON THE 2026 CAMPAIGN

MY TAKE

Everyone loved the ads, nobody came for the burgers. Liking is not buying, bhai. Cricket sponsors, are you listening?

MARKETING DIVE, 27 OCT · KANTAR

THE DUMP

What happened, and what I think.

1 RECKITT IS NOW TV'S BIGGEST SPENDER

TV ad volumes fell 6% in Jan–Sep. Reckitt overtook HUL and owns 7 of the top 10 TV brands. Biscuit ads grew 74%.

> *TV isn't dying, it's just changing owners.*

2 THE WORLD'S TOP 100 BRANDS: $3.9 TRILLION

48% of it is tech. NVIDIA grew 71.5%, Tesla fell 37.8%. Not one Indian brand made the list.

> *$3.9 trillion and zero Indian brands. That's the real number of the week.*

3 HYUNDAI MADE A NEWSPAPER TALK

A four-page Hindustan Times ad for the BAYON that plays audio, for a car with an AI voice assistant.

> *The car talks, so the ad talks. Medium is the demo. Love.*

THE DUMP, CONT'D

Big brands are rewriting the rules.

4 CLOROX KILLED THE ANNUAL CAMPAIGN

Pine-Sol now posts 150+ pieces a month and keeps improving them after launch.

> *The one big annual campaign is dying. Brands now ship content like app updates.*

5 SEPHORA BECAME "SETHPHORA"

Seth Rogen plays a clueless gift shopper who calls pimple patches "face stickers".

> *Selling beauty to people who know nothing about beauty. Diwali gifting brands, take notes.*

6 AUDI'S BILLBOARDS GIVE DIRECTIONS TO DONATE BLOOD

Signs in seven Danish cities: "Turn right in 250 metres and save up to three lives."

> *A car brand that gives directions. The purpose was hiding inside the product.*

CAMPAIGN OF THE WEEK

LA ÚLTIMA RISA

Patrón put on a comedy show about death.



PATRÓN · NEW YORK

WHAT THEY DID

For Día de Muertos, Patrón staged a one-night, 75-minute multilingual stand-up show at The Stand in New York on 2 Nov, backed by paid social and posters across the city.

MARKETING DIVE, 27 OCT

CAMPAIGN OF THE WEEK

ONE NIGHT.

75 minutes of jokes about death, on the festival that celebrates the dead.

THE INSIGHT

Día de Muertos already laughs at death. People write *calaveritas literarias*, satirical verses about it, every year.

THE MOVE

Go deep on one ritual of the festival, not the festival in general.

HOW IT WORKS

1
PICK A RITUAL
The satirical death verses.

2
MAKE IT LIVE
Turn the verses into a stand-up night.

3
MAKE NOISE
Paid social and posters across New York.

WHY I PICKED IT

Every brand does "festive vibes". Patrón picked one tiny ritual and made a whole night out of it. Diwali has a hundred rituals like that no brand owns yet.

WILD BRAND IDEA

WE SWITCHED NUTELLA FOR PEANUT BUTTER. BRO, THERE'S ONE LEVEL AFTER THAT.

Sesame, or til butter.

CATEGORY

Spreads. We've all switched from Nutella to peanut butter, thinking we're being very healthy.

WHITE SPACE

Til butter: same calories, same sugar, almost the same protein. **But 15x the calcium and 6x the iron.**



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MEET GUDSEED.

Sesame butter, sweetened with gud.

THE RANGE

- **GUDSEED BLACK**
  Black sesame. The calcium hero on your morning toast.
- **GUDSEED NUT**
  White sesame and peanut, for your post-workout snack.
- **GUDSEED MELT**
  Sesame and cacao, for when you crave Nutella.



THE LAUNCH

GUDSEED THELA: this winter, moongfali carts across Delhi serve hot toast with GUDSEED.

POSITIONING

SESAME BUTTER THAT TASTES LIKE WINTER GAJAK.

8 g protein, same as peanut butter. But 15x the calcium.

NUMBER OF THE WEEK

60/60

NUTRACEUTICAL ADS REVIEWED BY ASCI THAT NEEDED CHANGES, BECAUSE THE CLAIMS COULDN'T BE BACKED UP.

29 were changed or pulled without a fight

$9.9M Ace Blend just raised, partly to fund clinical trials

MY TAKE

Every. Single. One. If your protein powder needs a disclaimer longer than the label, the problem isn't the ad.

CAMPAIGN INDIA, 29 OCT · INC42, 29 OCT

INDIAN BRAND WATCH

Five moves worth stealing.



INSTAMART

A man wears a chandelier to sell Diwali decor.



SPOTIFY

The Gullak family fights through Diwali chores.



LICIOUS → SIZZL

Heat-and-eat range relaunched with a microwave rave.



HOCCO

Enters Kolkata with a Payesh flavour for Pujo.



MCDONALD'S INDIA

G-DRAGON's gochujang sauce, on McSpicy Paneer.

THE PATTERN

Everyone borrowed something people already love and matched it to make their brand relevant in that occasion or context.

HIDE THE THING YOU'RE SELLING.

Škoda blacked out its own car. BBH India's "Says It All." for the Slavia.

OUR VERSION OF A REDACTED AD

THE NEW [redacted] IS HERE.

It has [redacted], a [redacted] engine and [redacted] of boot space. Starting at ₹[redacted].

WILD GYAAN · THE CURIOSITY GAP

George Loewenstein: curiosity is an itch we get when we notice a gap between what we know and what we want to know. Too little and nobody cares. Everything and there's nothing to wonder about. Read: *Made to Stick*, Chip & Dan Heath.

1

HIDE ONE THING

The product, the price or the name.

2

MAKE IT SPECIFIC

A precise gap, not a vague tease.

3

PAY IT OFF

Reward the people who looked.

AI & MARKETING

What the machines did to marketing this week.

1 GOOGLE'S AI SEARCH EARNS LESS PER SEARCH

Search ad growth slowed to 12% (from 15%), even as searches hit a five-year high. Google blamed "the lower monetization we were seeing in AI Mode".

> *People are asking AI everything. If nobody remembers your brand's name, AI won't either.*

2 NEW CMOS ARE HIRED FOR AI SKILLS

26% of CMOs hired this year have AI skills, against 9% of those four or more years in. CMO tenure is down 35% since 2010.

> *AI on your CV is the new MBA. Not optional anymore, bas.*

WHERE DID THE MONEY GO?

$130.2M

raised by Indian startups across 32 deals, 26–30 Oct. D2C led ecommerce.

BRAND	WHAT IT SELLS	RAISED
TROOVY	Clean-label snacks for families	₹100 cr
ACE BLEND	Plant protein; funding clinical trials	$9.9M
ROTORIS	Invite-only luxury watches	$8.5M
REPLYALL	D2C ecommerce	$997K
ISLAND BEAUTY	D2C beauty	$271K

MY TAKE

Money is going to brands that can prove it. Trials, waitlists, repeat rates. Vibes aren't getting funded anymore.

PEOPLE MOVES

Who went where this week.

BK

BURGER KING INDIA

SUMIT ZAVERI → CEO

CFO since 2019, earlier at Nature's Basket and Tata Starbucks.

G

GREY 82.5 · OGILVY GROUP

SHOUVIK ROY → CEO

Ex-head of Ogilvy Delhi, who helped create Paperboat, returns.

RJ

RELIANCE JEWELS

GOPA KUMAR → HEAD

After seven years as COO of Bhima Jewels.

LIV

LIQUID I.V. · UNILEVER

JENNY DANZI → CMO

Former CMO of Poppi, 17+ years at PepsiCo.

MEDIANEWS4U 31 OCT · CAMPAIGN INDIA 29 OCT · MARKETING DIVE 28 OCT

THAT'S THE DUMP.

See you next Monday.

MARKETING WEATHER

↑	↓	‼
RISING	**COOLING**	**STORMY**
Brands that bring proof	Mega sponsorships	Supplement claims

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Wild Brand Ideas & Stories for you!